

WOOKYOUNG KIM, Ph.D.

Senior Researcher, KIMM | Associate Professor, UST | Thermal Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Ph.D. thermal engineer with 10+ years in electronics cooling and two-phase heat transfer, from pulsating heat pipes (KAIST) to AI data center cooling (DLC, immersion, jet impingement) as PI/project lead at Korea's national research institute (KIMM). Combines hands-on experimental expertise (-220°C / 100 MPa testing, hydrogen heat exchangers, heat pumps) with production-grade software development (Python / FastAPI / React Native). Lab-to-market record: 5 technology transfers, 18 domestic + 1 U.S. patents, 20 journal papers (12 SCI + 8 KCI), 8 registered design programs.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Thermal Management	Energy Systems	System Design & Testing	Software & Analysis
Data center cooling (ILC/DLC)	Heat pump (vapor./ads.)	Heat exchanger (PCHE/S&T)	Python / FastAPI / React Native
Immersion / Jet impingement	Liquid hydrogen vaporizer	Thermal loop construction	2-phase HT measurement
Electronics thermal design	Low-GWP refrigerant R&D	High-pressure / cryogenic sys.	VLE measurement & EOS

EXPERIENCE

Associate Professor | University of Science and Technology (UST) Sep 2026 - Present

Senior Researcher | Korea Institute of Machinery and Materials (KIMM) Jun 2021 - Present [Project page »](#)

Data Center Thermal Management

- Jet-enhanced immersion cooling for next-gen high-heat-density servers [PI, 2025]
- Immersion cooling waste heat utilization and active thermal management [Lead, 2024-2028]
- Direct liquid cooling (DLC) system for data center power-consumption reduction [Lead, 2026-2029]

Cryogenic / Hydrogen Heat Exchangers

- PCHE design & testing for liquid-hydrogen vaporizers: cryogenic testing to -220°C / 100 MPa [Lead, 2021-2026]
- Anti-freezing PCHE design; CFD conjugate heat transfer analysis; freezing condition experimental mapping [Lead]
- Compact PCHE development for below -200°C, 100 MPa-class hydrogen supply system [Lead, 2022-2026]

Heat Pumps & Refrigerants

- 300°C-class high-temperature heat pump system for fossil fuel replacement [Participant, 2023-2028]
- Chemisorption heat pump with electrochemical compressor; experimental characterization [Participant, 2021-2025]
- Low-GWP refrigerant VLE measurement (R-32/R-125, R-1233ZD(E)) and equation-of-state development [Participant]

Engineering Software & Apps

- AI-based automated design tool for data center DLC cooling systems [PI, 2026]
- KIMMPROP: iOS/Android thermophysical-property app (CoolProp/REFPROP via WASM) [PI, 2025] [App Store »](#) [Google Play »](#)
- 8 registered engineering design programs (PCHE, heat-pump cycle, vapor chamber, etc.) [Lead]

Impact: 20 journal papers (12 SCI + 8 KCI) | 18 domestic patents + 1 U.S. patent | 8 registered software | 5 technology transfers

EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Mechanical Engineering	KAIST	2017 - 2021
	<i>Dissertation: Study on a Thermal Network-based Model for Predicting the Thermal Resistance of Pulsating Heat Pipes</i> <i>Advisor: Prof. Sung Jin Kim</i>		
M.S.	Mechanical Engineering	KAIST	2015 - 2017
	<i>Thesis: Effect of artificial cavities on the thermal performance of pulsating heat pipes</i> <i>Advisor: Prof. Sung Jin Kim</i>		
B.S.	Mechanical Engineering	KAIST	2011 - 2015

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

20	18	1	8	5
Journal Papers (12 SCI + 8 KCI)	Domestic Patents	U.S. Patents	Registered Software	Tech Transfers

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- (1) **W. Kim** et al., "Freezing Phenomenon in PCHE for Cryogenic LH2 Vaporizer," Appl. Therm. Eng. 273 (2025)
- (2) **W. Kim** et al., "Freezing Condition of PCHE for LH2 Vaporizer," J. Hydrogen New Energy 35(2) (2024)
- (3) **W. Kim** et al., "Falling Film Evaporation of R-1233ZD(E): Flow & Thermal Characteristics," Korean J. ACRE 36(1) (2024)
- (4) **J.S. Kim, W. Kim** et al., "Pool boiling of ammonia outside enhanced tubes," Appl. Therm. Eng. 247 (2024)
- (5) **H.S. Kim, W. Kim** et al., "Chemisorption heat pump performance under various conditions," Appl. Therm. Eng. (2024)
- (6) **D.H. Kim, W. Kim** et al., "VLE of R-32/R-125: experiment and EOS verification," J. Mech. Sci. Technol. (2024)
- (7) **J. Kim, W. Kim** et al., "Liquid behavior in falling-film evaporator distributor," Physics of Fluids 35 (2023)
- (8) **W. Kim** and S.J. Kim, "Fundamental issues about pulsating heat pipes," J. Heat Transfer - ASME 143 (2021)
- (9) **W. Kim** and S.J. Kim, "Flow behavior effect on pulsating heat pipes," Int. J. Heat Mass Transfer 149 (2020)

SELECTED PATENTS

Showing 8 of 18 domestic patents (Korean Intellectual Property Office)

• Immersion cooling device	2024
• Immersion cooling HVAC system and method	2022
• Heat exchanger with anti-freezing capability	2023
• Micro-channel reactor	2023
• Ternary refrigerant composition and heat pump system	2022
• Adsorption heat pump evaporator and system	2023
• Heat pipe integrated reactor for adsorption heat pump	2022
• Geothermal heat supply device and heating system	2023

REGISTERED SOFTWARE PROGRAMS

All 8 programs registered with Korea Copyright Commission [Details »](#)

• 100 kg/hr hydrogen PCHE design program	2025
• Adsorption cooling simulation program	2025
• PCHE thickness design program	2024
• Vapor chamber performance analysis program	2024
• High-temperature heat pump cycle design program	2024
• Fin-tube heat exchanger design program	2024
• Heat exchanger HTC uncertainty analysis program	2023
• Lab-scale heat exchanger analysis program	2023

TECHNOLOGY TRANSFERS

5 transfers to industry partners

- Heat pipe and vapor chamber structural design for electronics cooling
- Micro-channel bonding and fabrication techniques for heat exchangers
- Low dew-point dehumidifier development technology
- Ultra-thin vapor chamber for next-generation semiconductor cooling
- Compact inverter compressor-based dress care system development

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Experimental: Thermal loop design & construction (1-/2-phase) · Low-GWP refrigerant systems · 2-phase flow & heat-transfer measurement · High-pressure testing (100 MPa) · Cryogenic systems (-220°C) · Flow visualization

Analytical & Computational: Thermal network modeling · Heat exchanger design (PCHE, S&T, PHE) · CFD (ANSYS FLUENT, COMSOL) · CAD (SOLIDWORKS, INVENTOR) · Surrogate modeling & design optimization · CoolProp/REFPROP

Software Development: Python · JavaScript/TypeScript · C/C++ · FastAPI · React / React Native · Git · Docker · Linux

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Council Member**, Korean Society of Mechanical Engineers (KSME) [2026.04 - Present]
- **Committee Member - Thermal Management / Cooling**, SAREK Data Center Facility Technology Division Committee [2026.03 - Present]
- **Regular Member**, Society of Air-Conditioning and Refrigerating Engineers of Korea (SAREK) [2022.04 - Present]
- **Regular Member**, Korean Society of Mechanical Engineers (KSME) [2021.05 - Present]